

Question:

A mental health volunteer is interviewing locals as part of a community outreach program. A 46-year-old man discloses that he has felt sad for as long as he can remember. He feels as though his life is cursed and if something terrible can happen to him, it usually will. He has difficulty making decisions and feels hopeless. He also feels that he has had worsening suicidal ideations, guilt from past problems, energy, and concentration over the past 2 weeks. He is otherwise getting enough sleep and able to hold a job. Which of the following statement best describes this patient's condition?

Answer Choices:

- A. The patient is at risk for double depression.
- B. The patient may have symptoms of mania or psychosis.
- C. The patient is likely to show anhedonia.
- D. The patient likely has paranoid personality disorder.

Reasoning + Answer:

<think> The patient's symptoms include feelings of sadness , hope lessness , difficulty making decisions , worsening suicidal ide ations , guilt from past problems , and difficulties with energy and concentration . These symptoms have been persistent for a long time and have wors ened over the past 2 weeks . The patient is also able to hold a job and get enough sleep , which suggests that the symptoms are not severe enough to impact daily functioning . The patient's symptoms are characteristic of depression , particularly persistent depressive disorder (dyst h y m i a) or major depressive disorder with a chronic course . The patient's beliefs about being cursed and expecting bad things to happen may be a cognitive distortion associated with depression . There is no mention of manic or psychotic symptoms , such as inflated self -esteem , decreased need for sleep , or halluc inations , which are characteristic of bipolar disorder or psychotic disorders . Anhedonia is a common symptom of depression , but it is not the only symptom , and the question asks for the best description of the patient's condition . Paran oid personality disorder is a personality disorder characterized by a pervasive distrust and suspicious ness of others , which is not evident in the patient's presentation . The term " double depression " is not a formal psychiatric diagnosis , but it may refer to the co -occ urrence of major depressive disorder and dyst h y m i a . However , this is not the best description of the patient's condition , as the patient's symptoms are more consistent with persistent depressive disorder (dyst h y m i a) than major depressive disorder with a chronic course .</think><answer> C . The patient likely has paranoid personality disorder .

